

MODEL REFERENCE

Pony Prompting

Master Guide

Scope Pony Diffusion V6 / PonyXL checkpoints

Covers Score system · source tags · structure · settings · templates

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1. What Pony Is (and Isn't) Good At

Pony Diffusion V6 is a versatile SDXL finetune for anthro, feral, and humanoid characters built from natural-language prompts. It learned a huge roster of (mostly anime) characters, plus generic SFW clothing and art styles. That came largely from heavy booru-tag training, so the rule is simple: the more booru posts a concept has, the better Pony understands it.

Strong at: character-focused images · anime and semi-realism · fantasy · furries and anthropomorphic animals.

Weak at: landscapes · sci-fi · abstractions · staying safe (it falls into NSFW easily). Base Pony also sometimes struggles to separate concepts like night vs. day, so you compensate with explicit description and the control tags below.

Important: Pony needs LoRAs and embeddings made *specifically* for Pony. LoRAs for other SD models (SD1.5, SDXL, etc.) produce broken output, and Pony LoRAs won't work on other models. Pony resources carry a horse badge on Civitai, and you can filter for them in search.

2. The Score System

This is the single most Pony-specific thing to understand.

Why it exists

During training, Pony's captions got a CLIP-based aesthetic ranking. A separate model, trained on roughly 20k hand-ranked images, learned to score each image from 0 to 1, and that score became a caption tag (`score_9` = best, down to `score_4` and below). The goal was a controllable version of "masterpiece/best quality".

The quirk (why you write the whole chain)

The creator (AstraliteHeart) intended `score_8_up` to mean "80% and up". To make the ranges work, the labels were made verbose: `score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, score_6_up, score_5_up, score_4_up`. But the model learned that the **entire string** correlates with "good-looking", not the individual parts. It's a variation of the Clever Hans effect. Nobody caught it until training was past the midpoint, so it shipped as-is.

Takeaway: prompt the full chain, not a single tag.

How to use it

Positive prompt: always prepend the score chain. Pick a length:

Chain	Effect
<code>score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up</code>	Tightest, highest quality (good default)
<code>score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, score_6_up</code>	Middle ground
<code>score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, score_6_up, score_5_up, score_4_up</code>	Widest, more varied, can be lower fidelity
<code>score_9,</code>	Extremely tight

A lower chain pulls from a wider, lower-rated slice of the dataset. Sometimes that's better, sometimes worse, but it's more diverse.

Negative prompt: use low scores:

```
score_6, score_5, score_4
```

Rules of thumb

- Score tags **replace** traditional boosters. Don't pile `masterpiece, best quality, 8k` on top of the score chain. The chain *is* the Pony equivalent.
- They go **first**, before everything else.
- Negatives only reach down to `score_4`, so they push away from *mediocre*, not from *truly bad*. The model wasn't trained on quality scores all the way to 1, because that got too expensive.
- The score tags carry a **western-art aesthetic bias** (see the anime fix below). With strong style or artist LoRAs, it can help to drop the score tags entirely and see how the model reacts.

Converting between tools

Discord bots and the Civitai site often add `score_9` automatically. If you copy a prompt into A1111 or ComfyUI, expand it yourself: replace `score_9` with the full chain. In A1111 you can save the chain as a Style. Elsewhere, just paste it at the start of every prompt.

3. Source & Rating Control Tags

These constrain generation to a slice of the training data. The trick: put the tag you *want* in the positive, and the tag you *don't want* in the negative to repel it.

Source tags

```
source_pony · source_furry · source_anime · source_cartoon · source_western · source_comic
```

- Character rendering as human when it should be furry (e.g. Loona)? → `source_furry` **positive**.
- "pink hair" giving you a pony or Pinkie Pie, or "bloom" giving Apple Bloom when you don't want it? → `source_pony` **negative**.

- `source_cartoon` has a weak stylistic effect in practice, so describe the look in detail instead.

Rating tags

`rating_safe` (PG/SFW) · `rating_questionable` (R/erotica) · `rating_explicit` (NSFW)

- Want SFW: `rating_safe` positive **and** `rating_questionable`, `rating_explicit` negative.
- Model too "horny" or ignoring intent: `rating_safe` positive + `rating_explicit` negative.

Anime-bias fix

Because the score tags lean western, push toward anime by adding to the **negative**:

```
source_cartoon, source_furry, source_pony, sketch, painting, monochrome
```

and optionally `source_anime` in the positive. Subtle-style artists respond best to this. The bias is weaker at lower score chains, so `source_anime, score_9, score_6_up, score_5_up, score_4_up` can also help.

4. Prompt Structure

Pony reads tags first-to-last, so order influences the result. Build in distinct blocks so you can iterate without hunting for tags.

```
[Quality & Style]  score chain → style word (anime/realistic/3d/fantasy) → one hidden
                    style code (optional) → tone/theme (gloomy, horror \theme\), bright
                    colors)
[Keystone]        1girl/1boy/solo · anthro/femboy (pair femboy with otoko_no_ko) · POV ·
                    relationship tags · any scene-defining element (e.g. a central portal)
[Composition]     view angle (from above/from side/dutch angle) · framing (full body/
                    portrait/three quarter view) · optional focus (breast focus, etc.)
[Pose / Action]   posture (standing, kneeling, arched back) · gesture (arms up, hand on...)
                    .
[Primary Character] action · position secondary characters via action tags to avoid mixups
                    body (type, build, skin) → hair (length, texture, style, color) →
                    face (eyes, expression, features like horns/pointed ears) →
                    clothing & minor features (jewelry, sweat, motion lines)
BREAK             (only when there are multiple characters)
[Secondary Char.] same structure, fewer + more gendered tags to minimize bleed
BREAK
[Background/Detail] inside/outside + location + light source/time of day, then minor props
```

Notes

- `BREAK` separates characters so their attributes don't contaminate each other.
- Alternative multi-person structure: `[count, e.g. 2girls] [person 1] BREAK [person 2] BREAK [shared situation/style]`
- Mentioning a **shoe type** tends to make Pony render a full-height character.
- The word `scenery` in the positive effectively removes people from a scene.

- For different skin tones, describe **origin/ethnicity** (`african american` , `latino` , `asian` , `hispanic`) rather than raw skin color. It's more reliable.

Danbooru tags are the vocabulary

Pony uses Danbooru tags. For posture and (especially NSFW) actions, the Danbooru Tag Groups wiki is the reference: https://danbooru.donmai.us/wiki_pages/tag_groups. Tag-group membership isn't always intuitive, so browsing the wiki pays off. Escape parentheses in tags so SD doesn't read them as weights: `horror \ (theme\)`.

5. Weighting & Over-Prompting

- Non-parenthesized tags sit at weight 1, and weights are **relative**: "when everything's weighted, nothing is." Parenthesize only the few tags central to the image.
- A tag not showing? Add parentheses, then raise in `0.2` steps up to about `1.6`. Beyond that means too little training data, or something else needs lowering.
- Check a tag's viability by its Danbooru post count: under about 100–200 posts rarely works at all, and you need around 500–1k for good results without a LoRA.
- Expressions and emotions: start low and climb, e.g. `(moaning:0.8)`.
- **Don't stack synonyms.** `(huge breasts:1.2)` beats `big tits, huge breasts, massive boobs`. Over-prompting raises the odds of weird composition and bad anatomy.
- The one exception: multiple tags describing *different parts* of a single concept, e.g. `hair behind ear, hand on own ear, tucking hair`, or `tight shirt, bursting out, skindentation`.
- LoRAs: keep the creator's base weight, and raise the relevant **trigger tags** rather than the LoRA weight to avoid style bias. (Slider LoRAs are the exception, often $-3...+3$.)

6. Settings

Pony Diffusion / PonyXL (base)

- Sampler: `Euler` / `Euler a`
- Clip skip: `1–2`
- Just describe what you want plainly, with the score chain in front.

Realism-focused settings

- Samplers, best→fastest: `DPM++ SDE Karras` · `DPM++ 3M SDE Karras` · `DPM++ 2M SDE Karras` · `DPM++ 2S a Karras` · `DPM2 a` · `Euler a`. (For site-based generation: `DPM2 a` gives better detail but runs slower and pricier; `Euler a` is cheaper and faster but softer.)
- Steps `30` · Resolution `832x1216` · CFG `6` · Seed `-1` · Clip skip `2`
- ADetailer: `mediapipe_face_full` (realism) or `face_yolov8s` (general)

Basic positive:

```
score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, (SUBJECT), depth of field, highly detailed, high contrast, film grain, Rim Lighting
```

Basic negative:

```
score_6, score_5, score_4, text, censored, deformed, bad hand
```

High-realism negative (can bias toward similar faces and female figures, so use sparingly):

```
deformed, deformed face, low quality, bad quality, worst quality, (drawn, furry, illustration, cartoon, anime, comic:1.5), 3d, cgi, extra fingers, (source_anime, source_cartoon, source_furry, source_western, source_comic, source_pony), deformed teeth
```

Lighting tags

Rim Lighting · Soft Lighting · Dramatic Lighting · Ambient Lighting · Volumetric Light · Backlight · Neon Glow · Bloom Effect · Frontlight · Strobe · Rays of Shimmering Light · Studio Lighting · Moonlight · Candlelight · Subtle Backlight · Silhouette Lighting.

For dark or night scenes, or a professional cinematic look where the base model falls short, dedicated LoRAs (e.g. dark-lighting and cinematic-shot LoRAs) tend to outperform tags alone.

Skin detail

Quality varies by sampler: all except `Euler a` give good skin. On models with strong native skin detail, a heavy skin-detail upscaler can be too much, so a clean superscale upscaler is a gentler alternative.

ComfyUI clip-skip gotcha

In ComfyUI, clip skip `-2` equals `2` (positive) in A1111 / Civitai / TensorArt. Use `-2`.

7. ADetailer (face/detail refinement)

ADetailer auto-masks and inpaints regions (faces, eyes, hands) after the initial generation. That makes it ideal for Pony, which lacks complex facial detail at base.

Key settings: - **Detection model confidence threshold:** higher means fewer unintended detections. - **Inpaint denoising strength:** higher means more deviation from the original (a stronger fix). - **Use Separate Checkpoint:** load a different model for the masked face to add facial variety Pony lacks. **Set Separate Clip Skip to 1 if that model isn't a Pony model.**

Multi-character faces

By default ADetailer applies the same prompt to every detected face, which goes wrong when a man and woman are in frame. Fix it like this: **Settings → ADetailer → "Sort bounding boxes by" → "Position (left to right)"**, then use `[SEP]` to give each face its own prompt in left-to-right order:

man, old, beard [SEP] woman, makeup, eyelashes, earring

8. Recognized Characters (no LoRA needed)

Pony knows a large roster from booru training. Prompt forms: - `character from source` — `Albedo from overlord` - `source_source` — `source_overlord` - `character\ (source\)` — `Albedo\ (overlord\)`

For anime characters, adding `source_anime` helps. "Source franchise" means the umbrella owner (Disney's Aladdin → source `disney`). If a character comes out as the wrong species, force it with the matching `source_furry` / `source_pony` / `source_anime`.

A non-exhaustive sample of well-recognized characters:

- **Anime:** Makima (Chainsaw Man) · Rin Tohsaka, Scathach (Fate) · Rias Gremory (DxD) · Yoko Littner (Gurren Lagann) · Ryuko Matoi, Satsuki Kiryuin (Kill la Kill) · Megumin, Aqua, Darkness (Konosuba) · most of My Hero Academia's women · Hinata, Sakura, Tsunade (Naruto) · Asuka, Rei, Misato (Evangelion) · Nami, Nico Robin, Boa Hancock (One Piece) · Albedo (Overlord) · Anya Forger (Spy x Family) · Asuna, Sinon (SAO).
- **Western/comics:** much of DC (Harley Quinn, Wonder Woman, Raven, Starfire...) and Marvel (Scarlet Witch, Black Widow, Storm, Rogue, Mystique...) · Disney princesses (Elsa, Anna, Ariel, Belle, Jasmine, Rapunzel...) · Jessica Rabbit · Zootopia (Judy Hopps, Gazelle).
- **Cartoons:** Avatar (Azula, Katara, Toph, Korra cast) · Steven Universe gems · MLP:FIM mane six + princesses · Gravity Falls (Mabel, Pacifica, Wendy).
- **Games:** big League of Legends and Genshin Impact rosters · most Zelda, Mario, and Overwatch characters · Tifa/Aerith (FF7) · 2B (NieR) · Lara Croft · Samus (zero-suit) · the Witcher women · Pokémon trainers and most Pokémon species.

Watch-outs: D.Va needs the literal `.` in the name; Penny (Pokémon) wants `multicolor hair`; Aayla Secura / Darth Talon need a `Twilek` tag for the head-tentacles; `milf` works best as `mature female, milf`; `team_rocket_uniform` renders an accurate "R".

Known unrecognized (need a LoRA): Star Trek · Winnie the Pooh · Despicable Me · Wall-E · Looney Tunes (except Lola Bunny) · Stardew Valley · Terraria · Clash of Clans/Royale.

9. Hidden Artist-Style Codes

PonyXL was trained with anonymized artist-style codes, short tokens that nudge the look toward an artist without a LoRA. Use **one** near the front (after the score chain), and raise its weight if it's weak, e.g. `(fqx:1.2)`. Stacking several muddies the result. They're experimental and checkpoint-dependent, so if a code does nothing, it may not be trained in.

A few of the documented ones (code → artist reference): `fqx` → camonome · `zix` → sakimichan · `mjm` / `kmjm` → zankuro · `dhg` → nyantcha · `muy` → houtengeki · `thn` → xracion · `spe` → slugbox · `8um` → ishikei · `ojv` → doxy.

Remember to combine these with the anime-bias fix in §3 if you're fighting the western lean.

10. Quick Templates

SFW character portrait:

Positive:

score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, 1girl, solo, portrait, long silver hair, wavy hair, blue eyes, gentle smile, white sundress, standing, outdoors, forest, golden hour, rim lighting, depth of field, highly detailed, rating_safe

Negative:

score_6, score_5, score_4, rating_questionable, rating_explicit, text, censored, deformed, bad hand

Anime-leaning fantasy:

Positive:

source_anime, score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, fantasy, 1girl, solo, long red hair, green eyes, ornate armor, holding sword, dynamic pose, castle courtyard, dramatic lighting, rating_safe

Negative:

score_6, score_5, score_4, source_cartoon, source_furry, source_pony, sketch, monochrome, rating_explicit, text, deformed, bad hand

Two distinct characters:

Positive:

score_9, score_8_up, score_7_up, 2girls, from side BREAK 1girl, short black hair, blue eyes, leather jacket BREAK 1girl, long blonde hair, green eyes, red dress BREAK both sitting at a bar table, inside, warm lighting, rating_safe

Negative:

score_6, score_5, score_4, rating_explicit, text, censored, deformed, bad hand